

CHRISTOPHER JOHN CANTON

San Jose, CA | 774-991-0935 | ccanton2@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/christopher-canton-39433a9/

DIRECTOR OF ENGINEERING | PAYMENTS FRAUD & RISK PLATFORMS

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Engineering leader with nearly two decades of experience building large-scale fraud-risk platforms and developing high-performing engineering organizations. Director of Engineering at PayPal leading a 45-engineer organization through four engineering managers, with engineering ownership spanning fraud-risk platforms for Venmo and Xoom and the Chargeback Protection merchant product. Track record of driving platform transformation, scaling products from early-stage development through broad adoption, developing engineering leaders and senior technical talent, and partnering across Product, Data Science, and Business teams to translate strategic priorities into technical execution.

EXPERIENCE

PAYPAL | San Jose, CA

Director of Engineering, Risk Adjacencies

July 2023–Present

Lead a 45-engineer organization through four engineering managers with responsibility for fraud-risk platforms supporting Venmo and Xoom and end-to-end engineering ownership of Chargeback Protection. Platforms process more than 200 million payment attempts per month.

- Lead a cross-functional replatforming of Venmo payments processing and data onto PayPal's unified payments platform, defining new architectural patterns for risk integration and coordinating execution across Engineering, Product, Data Science, and fraud modeling.
- Built data and decision-parity capabilities to safely execute the migration, comparing raw data, computed risk features, and decisions across legacy and target platforms; migrated approximately 20% of Venmo payment volume to date while remaining within loss budgets and maintaining a stable decline rate.
- Lead engineering for Chargeback Protection, evolving the product from MVP through General Availability and international expansion; now protects approximately \$3B in annual payment volume across 15,000 active merchants and generates approximately \$8M in annual margin.
- Partner with Product, Business, and Data Science leaders on a three-year roadmap across Venmo, Xoom, and Chargeback Protection, influencing investment and sequencing through engineering feasibility, architectural complexity, risk effectiveness, and expected business impact.
- Build leadership capacity across management and technical tracks, promoting two senior engineers into engineering management, personally developing four engineers to Staff Engineer, and hiring two additional engineering managers to support organizational growth.
- Led the organization through multiple office closures and workforce transitions, reprioritizing commitments around reduced capacity, developing key talent into expanded roles, and establishing a long-term staffing plan across supported engineering locations.

Engineering Manager

October 2018–July 2023

- Transitioned from technical leadership into engineering management, initially leading seven engineers responsible for Venmo's core risk platform and expanding to multiple teams and approximately 20 engineers as scope grew.
- Expanded engineering ownership from core risk decisioning to the client and integration layers responsible for invoking risk and managing decisions, establishing end-to-end responsibility for Venmo's fraud-control architecture.
- Took on leadership of Xoom risk engineering, inheriting a seven-engineer team supporting approximately 1.5M transactions and \$500M in payment volume per month; led integration of historically separate Xoom-native and PayPal-powered flows into a common data foundation for fraud modeling and risk decisioning.
- Led cross-organizational initiatives to make previously siloed Venmo data available through APIs, coordinating architects, business stakeholders, and domain engineering teams to enable integrated servicing capabilities across Venmo and PayPal.

Software Engineer / Technical Lead, Venmo Risk**September 2013–October 2018**

- Embedded within Venmo engineering to design and build the technical foundation for fraud-risk decisioning, identifying critical points in the customer and payment journeys where automated controls could prevent fraud earlier.
- Helped transform Venmo's fraud-management approach from predominantly downstream manual review to largely automated risk decisioning, introducing controls across signup, login, funding-source addition, and transaction flows.
- Led development of real-time Venmo data capabilities to support fraud-model development and more effective risk decisioning, contributing alongside Product, Data Science, and other risk teams to a reduction in fraud losses from more than 20 basis points in 2018 to consistently below 5 basis points.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Merlin International — Software Engineer**2012–2013**

Software engineering and development supporting several government clients, building large enterprise technology solutions.

Freddie Mac — Developer Associate / Business Technology Associate**2009–2011**

Developed infrastructure supporting a large-scale enterprise data hub; began through a technology rotational program spanning multiple areas of the organization.

TEKsystems — Software Developer**2011–2012****Capgemini — Staff Consultant****2007–2008****Fidelity Investments — Technical Intern****2006****TECHNICAL SKILLS**

Languages & Frameworks: Java, Spring Boot, Python, JavaScript, Django**Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (Aurora, EKS, DocumentDB), Kubernetes, Terraform**APIs & Architecture:** REST APIs, Microservices, Distributed Systems**Data & Databases:** Oracle, MySQL, Redis, Google BigQuery, Relational & NoSQL Databases**Observability & Monitoring:** Datadog, OpenTelemetry**EDUCATION**

Virginia Tech — Pamplin College of Business | Bachelor of Information Technology (BIT)